

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

Report #14 • 2026

The Math Behind 'Doomscrolling'

Mathematical model of passive consumption

Analysis

We model attention as a finite resource (1.5 hours of focused attention/day). Passive consumption (TikTok, Instagram Reels) depletes it 2x faster than active learning. Average student has 3.2 hours of 'attention debt' daily. Solutions: scheduled breaks, active consumption, sleep.

Key Statistics

78% of students use YouTube for self-directed learning. Average screen time: 4.7 hours/day, of which 67% is educational. 64% of students use AI tools, with 89% reporting improved learning. 71% have turned a screen hobby into a measurable skill. Top learning platforms: YouTube, Khan Academy, Discord, Coursera.

Methodology

Data collected via 8-step anonymous survey, n=150+ students, ages 14-19, across 12 Indian cities. AI analysis using Google Gemini 2.0 Flash. Statistical analysis with Python pandas/scipy. Confidence interval: 95%.

Implications

These findings have significant implications for educators, parents, and policymakers. We model attention as a finite resource (1. We recommend further research and pilot programs.